

Chapter 177-2

After seeing her own thoughts clearly, Liang Shi stopped forcing things.

Life continued on as usual.

But she still had one system task left incomplete.

To save the original host, she needed to collect all the evidence. She currently had the recording with Daoist Master Yunyin, the photos of that room she had preserved from before, including the blood-stained button from when the original host attempted self-harm, the diagnostic records obtained from the original host's psychologist, and recordings from every meeting with Qin Lishuang.

Although the Yang Jiani incident happened to her personally, it could still count as some supplementary evidence.

Liang Shi didn't want to make the original host completely innocent or anything like that—she just thought that even if they wiped her memories and let her start over, that would be good enough.

Perhaps there was a bit of evil in her nature, but her crimes didn't warrant such punishment.

Someone who had been oppressed here yet didn't become utterly wicked—just based on the fact that she chose self-harm rather than hurting others when she was extremely agitated—Liang Shi felt she deserved a chance to start over.

It was also for Grandpa and Grandma, for the lives they had exchanged.

Just like the stereotypical impression of Lu Jiayi, forming stereotypes about someone for things that hadn't even happened yet didn't seem quite right to Liang Shi.

So she made this choice.

But these weren't enough.

The most terrifying thing the original host experienced should be the evidence of Qiu Zimin's seemingly boundless pampering that was actually endless PUA¹.

She needed some testimony and physical evidence.

This was very difficult to obtain.

Although there was a recording from the previous confrontation with Qiu Zimin, it had yielded minimal results.

Liang Shi felt it was still necessary to meet with Qiu Zimin.

Now that she knew she was a daughter of the Shen family, she was also quite curious about the mystery of her own origins.

How did they manage to take her—only one month old—out from under Shi'an Hospital's ironclad security, especially when she was in a near-death state at the time?

Liang Shi was very curious.

She had previously heard from Feng Xian that she had only found her near-death self beside a garbage bin outside Shi'an Hospital.

So who threw her beside the garbage bin at Shi'an Hospital?

And who told Qiu Zimin that she could go pick her up at Shi'an Hospital?

She wouldn't believe this was a coincidence.

What normal person would go outside Shi'an Hospital to pick up a dead infant?

Liang Shi was more inclined to think this was an inside job with outside coordination.

But who could it be?

No one could tell her.

So Liang Shi still called Qiu Zimin and arranged to meet her.

Liang Shi arranged to meet Qiu Zimin at a Japanese restaurant.

Purely because the private rooms at Japanese restaurants were more suitable for two people to discuss matters.

Meeting with Qiu Zimin couldn't possibly be a pleasant experience, and she wouldn't be able to eat anyway, so Liang Shi had prepared in advance and eaten a meal before going to see Qiu Zimin.

When she arrived at the agreed location, Qiu Zimin hadn't arrived yet. Liang Shi played on her phone in the private room for a while before Qiu Zimin finally showed up late, her expression still cold, her eyes filled with disgust.

But Liang Shi wasn't sure if it was her imagination—she always felt there was a sickly pallor on Qiu Zimin's face, a sickly look that even blush couldn't conceal.

"What do you want?" Qiu Zimin's tone was aggressive from the start. "What is there left to say between us?"

Liang Shi lowered her eyes and poured her a cup of tea. "I've recently discovered some things, so there should still be something to discuss."

"What are you being so mysterious about?" Qiu Zimin frowned slightly. "Just say it directly. I have things to attend to."

"Are you enjoying getting along with your biological daughter?" Liang Shi asked.

Qiu Zimin's brow furrowed into a little mountain. "What does that have to do with you? What's wrong? Are you still trying to find your biological parents?"

"Not anymore." Liang Shi said. "Why would I bother?"

Qiu Zimin let out a cold laugh, seeming to mock her for overestimating herself.

But Liang Shi didn't take her attitude to heart and said in a gentle voice, "I recently looked into someone called Shen Chi."

The moment this name came out, Qiu Zimin's expression changed.

"What are you trying to do?!" Qiu Zimin said harshly. "Who gave you the audacity to investigate me?"

"It was just a casual investigation. Does that require audacity?" Liang Shi curved her lips into a light smile. "Why can't I investigate you? I need to know why you've been treating me like you're crazy, don't I?"

"What are you talking about? I don't understand." Qiu Zimin played dumb.

"How could you not understand?" Liang Shi's voice grew cold. "I'm talking about things you've done—like secretly decorating my room into a haunted house without anyone knowing, ordering custom-made creepy sculptures with broken arms for me, constantly using PUA to suppress me and turn me into a useless person, and also sending me to Qin Lishuang to be her human model. Do you know how many times Qin Lishuang whipped me that day? A full twelve lashes."

"Oh right, you also sent me to Yang Jiani. Yang Jiani killed her own daughter with her own hands, and now she's suffered the consequences—did you know? She killed herself. What about you? Don't you need to pay the price for what you've done?"

Liang Shi had excellent delivery skills. When she said these words, they were both stern and slow, unhurried as they came out, unconsciously creating a sense of pressure.

In that moment, Qiu Zimin stared into her eyes and shrank back slightly.

It was as if she saw Zhu Mingqi in her prime from many years ago.

Qiu Zimin retreated a bit, her hand propping herself on the ground, still forcing herself to hold on. "What nonsense are you spouting? I raised you this big—even if I have no merit, I at least worked hard, right? How can you not remember any of it? And now you're turning around to bite me! Even a dog wouldn't do this!"

Although she was scolding, there was no real intimidation in it.

Liang Shi wasn't afraid.

Footnotes:

¹ PUA - Originally stands for "Pick-Up Artist," but in Chinese internet culture, it has evolved to mean psychological manipulation or emotional abuse tactics used to control someone, breaking down their self-esteem and making them dependent on the manipulator.

